

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Cavernous Nerves by Electrical Stimulation with Penile Plethsmography

160.26

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

160.26

Manual Section Title

Cavernous Nerves by Electrical Stimulation with Penile Plethsmography

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

08/24/2006

Implementation Date

01/02/2007

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

In nerve-sparing prostatic and colorectal surgical procedures, the assessment of the function of the cavernous nerves by direct application of electrical stimulation with penile plethysmography is a diagnostic test, also referred to as cavernosal nerve mapping, which may be performed to assess the integrity of the cavernous nerves. Through an open or laparoscopic procedure, the surgeon may want to assess the function of the cavernous nerves by stimulating the most distal end of the nerve that can be located by using an electrical nerve stimulator. The presence of a response and the degree of the response may be used to provide the surgeon with a more realistic assessment of the chance of the patient regaining potency and assist in choosing appropriate therapy.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

Not applicable.

C. Nationally Non-Covered Indications

Effective August 24, 2006, Cavernous Nerves Electrical Stimulation with penile plethysmography is non-covered under Medicare. CMS reviewed the evidence and determined that this test is not reasonable and necessary for Medicare beneficiaries undergoing nerve-sparing prostatic or colorectal surgical procedures.

D. Other

Also see [§20.14, Plethysmography](#).

(This NCD last reviewed September 2006.)

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

61

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R61NCD.pdf>

Revision History

11/2006 -Is not reasonable and necessary for Medicare beneficiaries undergoing nerve-sparing prostatic or colorectal surgical procedures. Effective date 8/24/2006. Implementation date 01/08/2007. ([TN 61](#)) (CR 5294)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- Original Consideration for Cavernous Nerves Electrical Stimulation with Penile Plethysmography (CAG-00311N) [↗](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Cavernous Nerves by Electrical Stimulation with Penile Plethysmography	1	08/24/2006 - N/A	You are here